

South Portland fines property manager \$4,500 over common-area violations - Casco Bay Ledger

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South Portland fines property manager \$4,500 over common-area violations at Ocean Street building

SOUTH PORTLAND - The city's code enforcement office has fined Lakeshore Property Partners \$4,500 for violations at a 24-unit apartment building on Ocean Street, following tenant complaints about the condition of the building's common areas.

According to the notice of violation dated September 11, inspectors found accumulated trash in the rear stairwell, a non-functioning hallway light on two floors, and a laundry room that "had not been cleaned in a manner consistent with the city's property maintenance ordinance." The building is one of 12 that Lakeshore took over management of this month; the violations were cited after the transition date.

Tobias Renner, Lakeshore's Director of Operations, said in a statement that the company inherited the conditions and has already addressed the lighting. "We took on these buildings because they needed attention, and we are giving it to them. The common areas will be on a weekly cleaning schedule with a contracted vendor by the end of October."

A tenant who asked not to be named said the stairwell had been in that condition "since at least July," before Lakeshore's involvement.

The fine is due within 30 days. A follow-up inspection is scheduled for October 14.

Reporting by the Casco Bay Ledger local desk. This is a fictional news item created for a training exercise.